

Unit Outline

1. Religious & Social Influence on Nursing in Medieval Time

- Influence of Epidemics in Nursing
- Influence of wars on Nursing

2. Influence of religions on Nursing

- Christianity
- Islam
- Buddhism
- Hinduism

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3. Medicine and Nursing in Medieval Time

4. The dark era of Nursing

Influence of Religions 2 on Nursing



- **Christianity**
- Islam
- Buddhism
- Hinduism



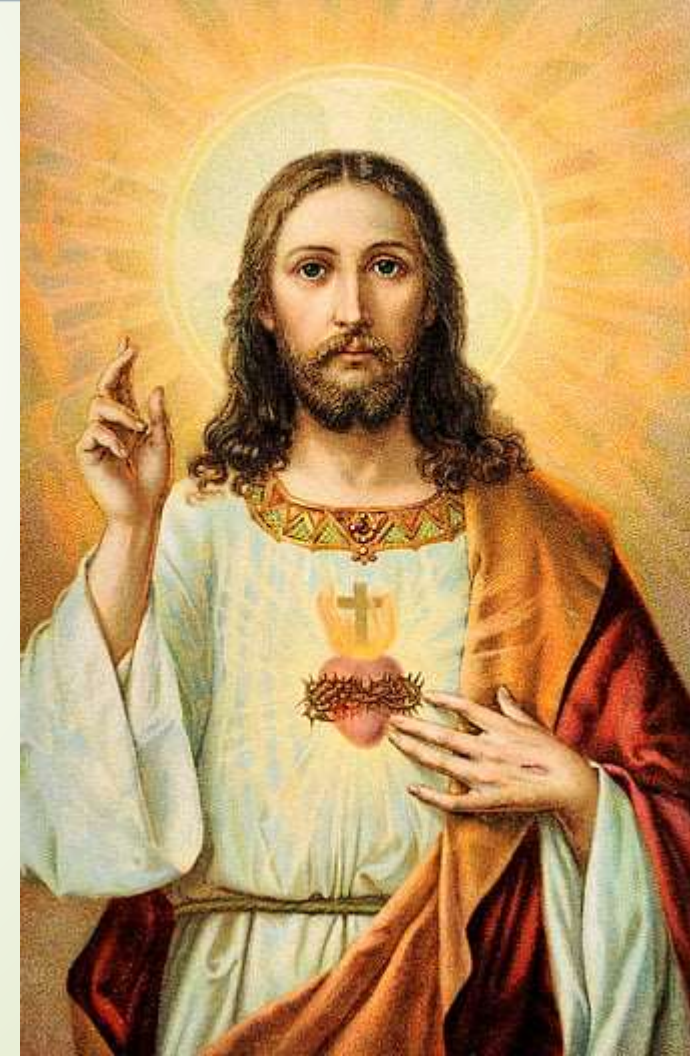
Nursing in Early Christian Era (1AD – 500 AD)

- Teaching of Jesus Christ was different from other religions in Rome.
- Jesus Christ did not accept illness as a punishment or influence of evil.
- He healed all kinds of diseases and brought humanity into religious teachings.

‘Love your neighbor as yourself’

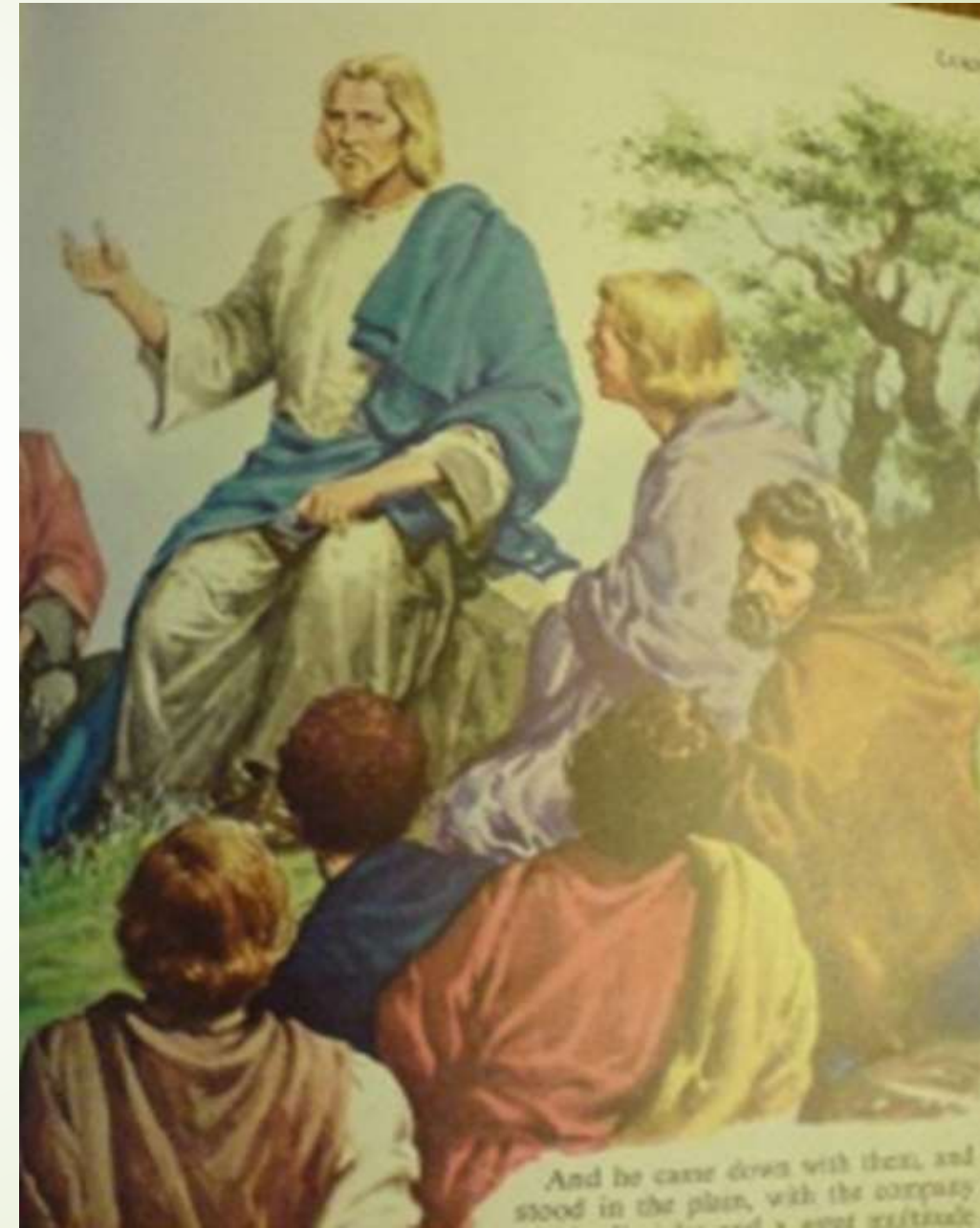
‘Do good & expect no reward.
Do it for God and to be like him’

- Those teachings were very helpful for the people toward give up anger & injustice and developing kindness , love and compassion.
- People realized the importance of caring for patients and helping poor.



With Jesus Christ's teaching of love and care,

- * Churches established.
- * Groups organized as orders to care for the sick, the poor, orphans, widows, the aged, slaves and prisoners.



And he came down with them, and stood in the plain, with the company gathered about him.

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- Rich and educated people started to help the poor. Other people also joined them.
- They were called as **‘Deacons’**



- Church taught **equality** of all men and women.
- Women assisted the clergy in the work of church.
These women were appointed to help the Deacons
They were called as '**Deaconesses**'.



- Women offered great service to the society by visiting sick. Therefore, they got a special place in the society.



As a result

Women's organizations developed.

Organization of Widows & Virgins

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1. The Deaconesses

- ➡ Unmarried women.
- ➡ They practiced ‘works of mercy’ (feeding, clothing, caring), preaching and teaching.
- ➡ They visited patients in their homes. Hence, they were called as ‘**Visiting Nurses**’.
- ➡ It is believed that this was the origin of current ‘**Public Health Nurse**’.

a). Phoebe

- The **first visiting nurse.**
- Follower of St. Vincent de Paul
- A kind-hearted and dedicated deaconess.



2. Order of widows

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- Consisted of widows or unmarried women.
- Worked religiously.
- More responsible.
- Well disciplined.

3. Order of Virgins

- Consisted of virgins.
- Highly recognized by society.
- Performed similar work of clergy in church
- Distributed goods among poor.

- ➡ Later the women of both organizations were promoted as '**Nuns**' and '**Mother of Nuns**'.
- ➡ In 4th and 5th centuries Roman women of high rank had a great freedom.
- ➡ They engaged in social services, specially in caring the sick.
- ➡ They gave their wealth to charity and nursing.
- ➡ There were **three Roman Matrons** who dedicated for the social wellness.

a). Marcella

Rich lady , lived in Aventine Hill.

Friend of Paula and Fabiola.

Converted her luxurious home into a monastery for teaching Catholic.

Did instruction and charitable work.



b). Fabiola

Charming, rich lady who got married two times and had unsuccessful marriage life.

She donated her beautiful palace to make

first public hospital in Rome.



c). Paula

Rich, educated lady.

After the death of her spouse, she studied Christianity.

Later visited Palestine and Jerusalem.

Cared the sick and travelers in Jerusalem.

Built monasteries and hospitals.

Served people for 20 years and died in 401 AD.

- ➡ These three Roman Matrons helped St. Jerome (Catholic Clergy) for his religious services.



Aventine Hill in Rome



Special **Institutions** for Caring the Sick and Poor.

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1. 'Diakonia'

Established by Decons and Deconesses.

Administration of diakonia was done by the church.

2. Bishops opened their homes for the poor and sick.

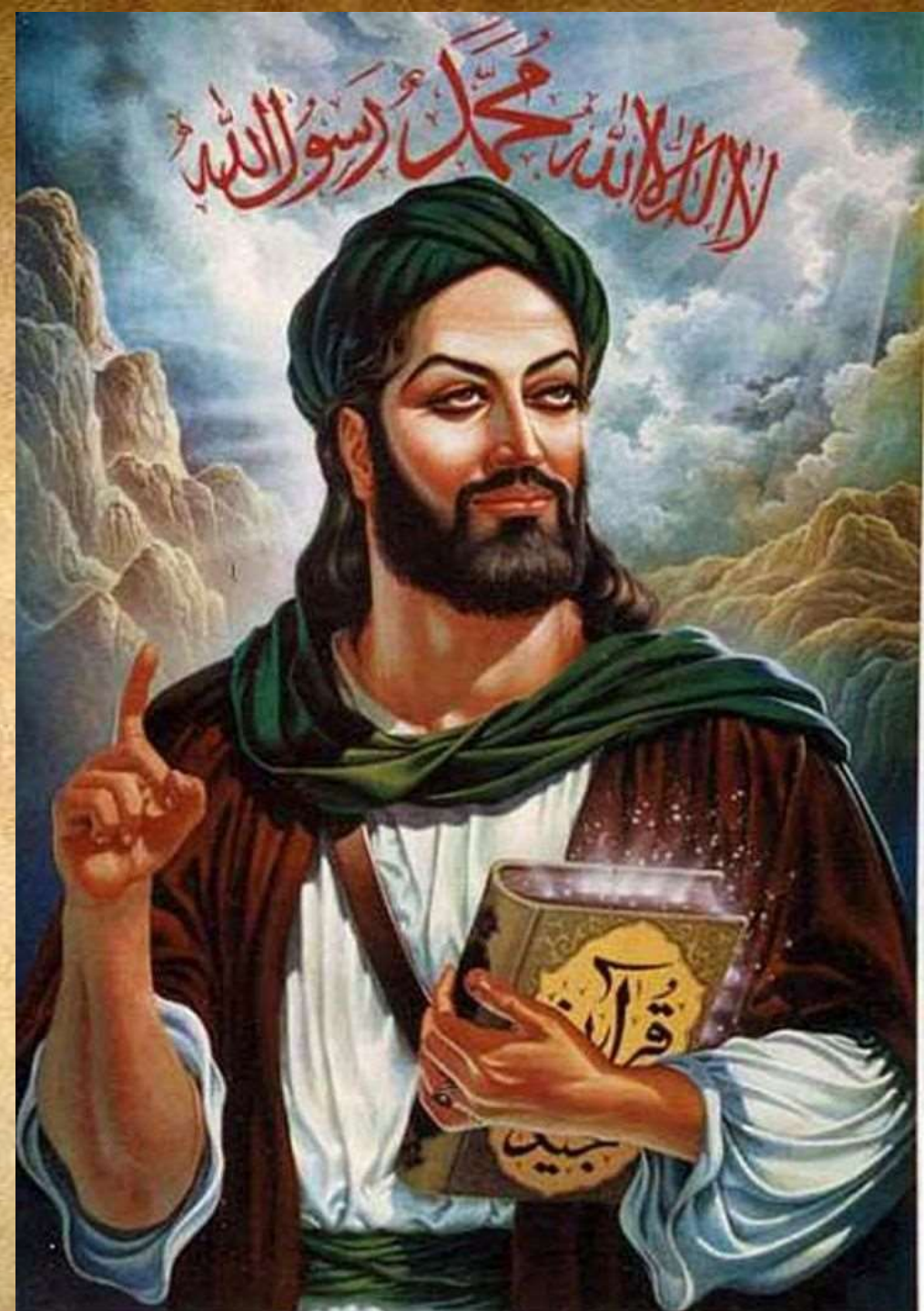
3. **Xenodochion** (Means 'promise of permanency')

- As the Bishops' houses were too small, the Christian '**Xenodochion**' grew up.
- That is the permanent place where assisting the poor, sick, aged and travelers.
- In 308 AD - Emperor Constantine established Xenodochion.
- End of the 4th century Bishop St. Basil established '**Xenodochion of Basil**'

Accordingly, Christianity was a great favor for the development of nursing.

Though people dislike to treat patients with offensive surgical wounds, according to the Jesus' teaching they motivated to perform such type of caring.

- Christianity
- **Islam**
- Buddhism
- Hinduism



‘Allah has not made a disease without appointing a remedy for it, with the exception of one disease, namely old age’

Muhammad Nabhi:

Born around 570 AD.

He was the prophet and founder of Islam.

He was considered as an agent from the God .

Allah Muhammad's teaching was written in a holy book called 'Kuran'.



- By 700 AD, Arab was the most powerful state.
- People strictly followed their religious leader's teachings.
- They lived with many difficulties as Arab was mostly consisted with deserts.
- They destroyed other religion's sacred places and spread their religion.
- Their sacred city was Macca, where Muhammad was born.
- For religious activities, a mosque had been built in Macca.

Mecca at Saudi Arabia



- Muslims did not accept Hippocrates and Galen's view points on medicine.
- They wanted to find their own way (according to Muhammad's teachings) of treating illnesses.
- 'Kalifs' were the leaders and after the demise of Muhammad, they developed literacy.
- They translated Hippocrate's and other's findings on medicine into Arabic language.

- All schools combined to the mosque.
- Later these schools developed as universities.
- Those universities were well facilitated as universities in England.
- Motivated to study on medicinal drugs.
- Gradually Pharmacology also included in Islam.
- Started schools to teach Pharmacology and compiled books on pharmacology.

- ➡ Had well developed hospitals.
- ➡ Performed suturing and cauterization.
- ➡ Used some fumes for anesthesia.
- ➡ Discovered 'catgut' for suturing.
- ➡ Introduced case history and clinical teaching for the first time.
- ➡ There were consultants in medicine

- Muslims treated and cared patients with psychiatric illness more than Catholics.
- Had separated and well facilitated hospitals for these patients.
- Women were appointed for the service in hospitals.
- But were prohibited to care patients other than making beds.
- Uneducated but experienced women had given care during labour.
- Female muslims had a low social state.

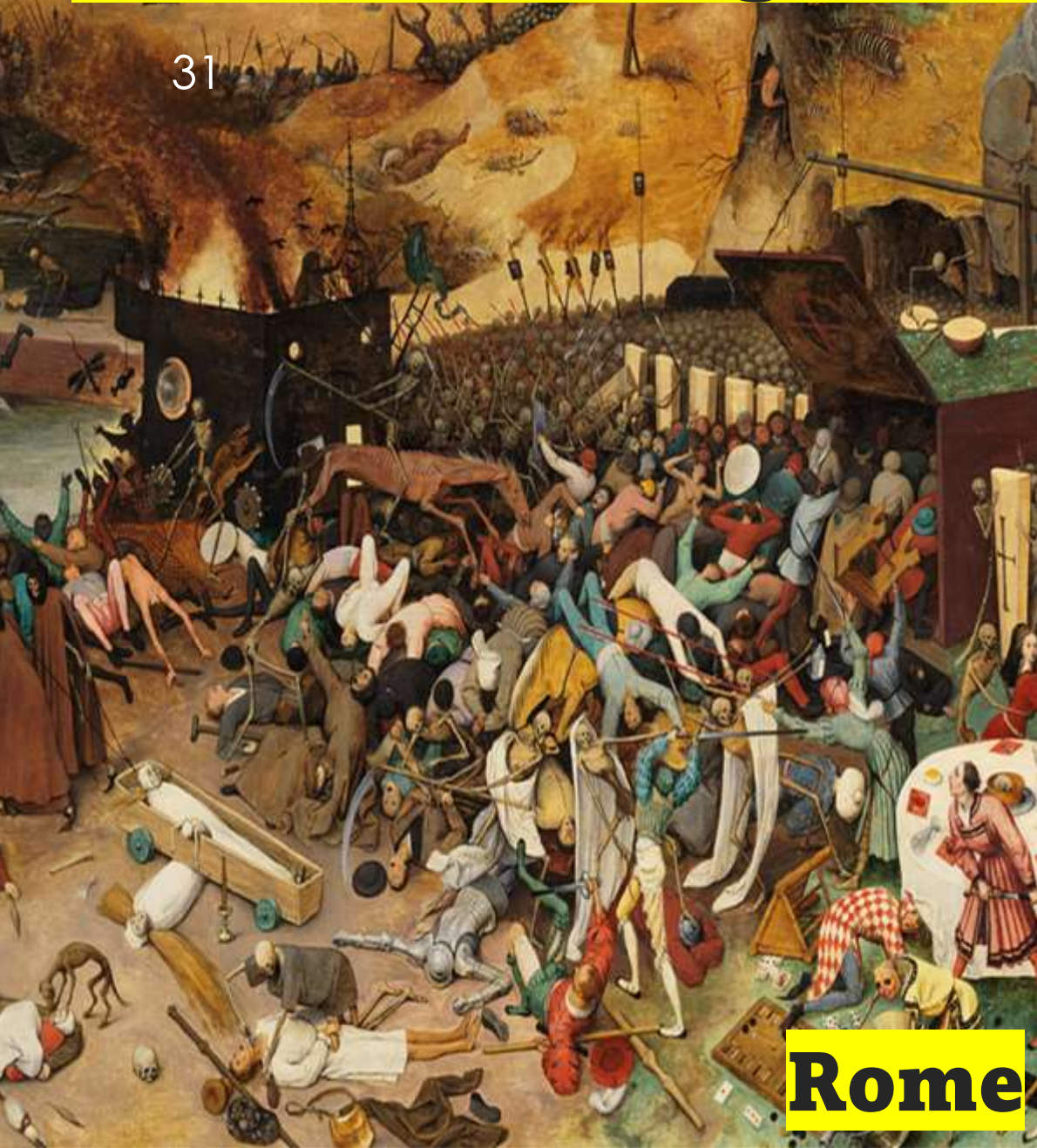
- By 11th century Muslims had a great development in all areas.
- They conquered Christian's sacred Jerusalem.
- They, produced papers for writing,
Found Arabic numeral
Developed medicine
Advanced culture
- Later Muslim state was divided among three Kalifs and dwindled its power .



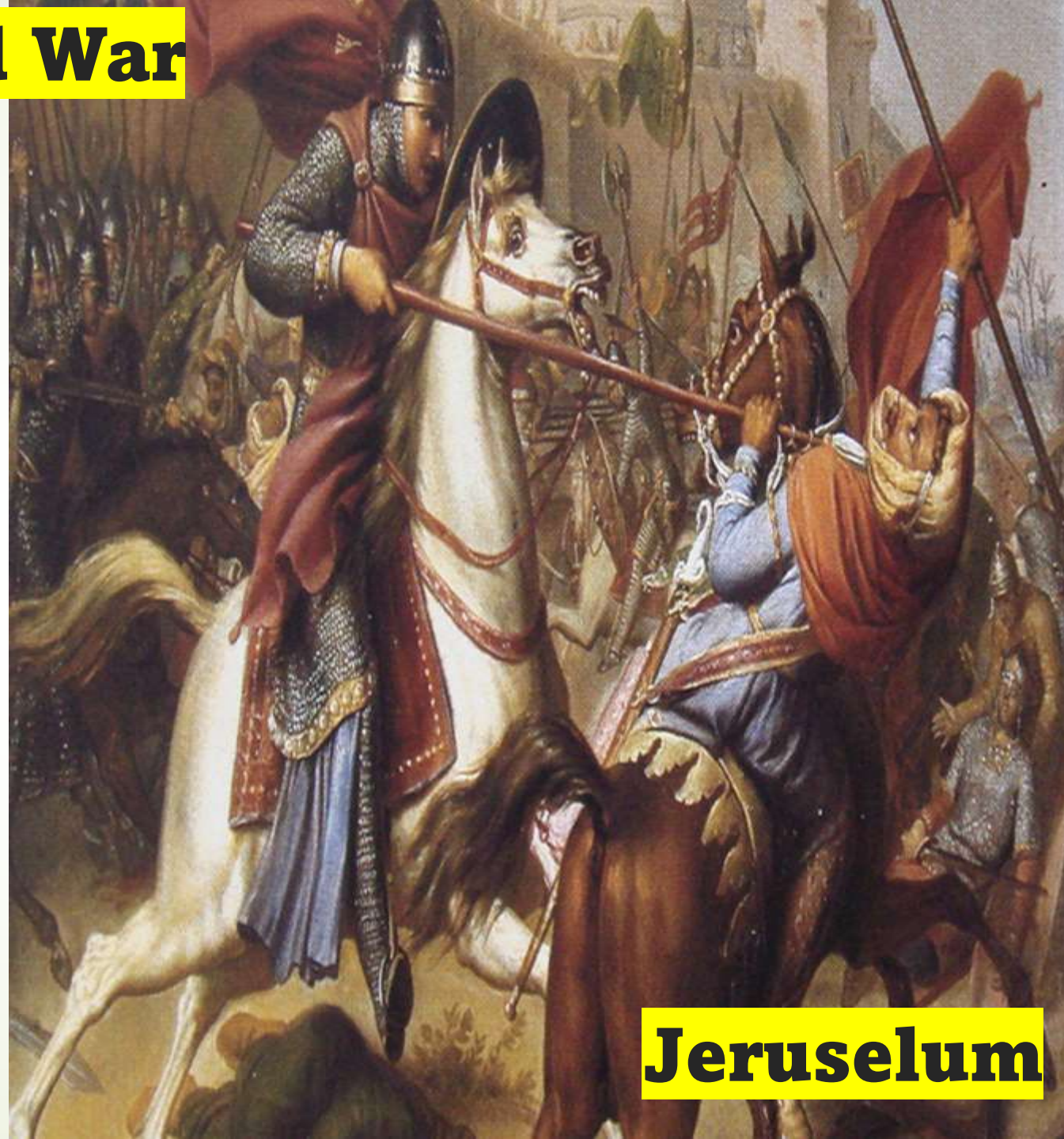
Summary

Influence of Plague and War

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Rome



Jerusalem



Plague



Monasteries

Nuns and priests



Religious Organizations

War



Knightly Military Orders

Knight Hospitallers

1. Knights of Saint John
2. Teutonic Knights
3. St. Lazarus Knights

Non- Religious Organizations

Assignment - 01

Short Essay Question

1) Influence of religion on Nursing, Medicine, and Health.

- Buddhism

- Hinduism

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Thank you

